

Spring Boot Startup — Interview Answer

What happens when a Spring Boot application starts?

The Answer (sav this)

When a Spring Boot app starts, it all begins with **SpringApplication.run()** in the main method. That does four main things: first, it creates the **application context**, which is the IoC container that holds all the beans. Then it does **component scanning** to find all my classes annotated with `@Service`, `@Repository`, and so on. Next, **auto-configuration** kicks in based on the libraries on my classpath — for example, if there's a web dependency, it sets up an embedded **Tomcat** server. Finally, it creates all the beans and **injects their dependencies**, and if it's a web app, it starts Tomcat on **port 8080** and the app is ready to serve requests.

The flow in one line

main() → run() → create context → component scan → auto-configure → create & inject beans → start embedded server → ready

Keywords the interviewer is listening for

- **SpringApplication.run()** — the entry point
- **Application context** / IoC container — holds all beans
- **Component scanning** — finds `@Service`, `@Repository`, etc.
- **Auto-configuration** + **classpath** — configures defaults from your libraries
- **Beans + dependency injection** — created and wired together
- **Embedded Tomcat** on **port 8080** — app is ready

Delivery tips

- Use signpost words: *first... then... next... finally*.
- Give the 30-second version, then stop — let them ask for more.
- Stay calm; a clear 30 seconds beats a rushed 90.
- Be ready for follow-ups: *What is the application context?* and *What does auto-configuration do?*